BABYSTEPS · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Budget

What it costs to run BabySteps now and at 100, 1,000 and 5,000 active families.

PROJECT
BabySteps

PREPARED BY
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VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

> Prices below come from public pricing pages read on the dates shown. Usage numbers are my assumptions and are marked Estimate. Replace them with real usage once the app has it. ESTIMATE

Summary

At 100 active families the app costs roughly $93 a month with the larger model or $53 with the smaller one, almost all of it hosting. At 1,000 families the AI line starts to matter. The smaller model keeps the AI cost under $21 a month at that size. ESTIMATE

Pricing inputs

ITEM	PRICE	SOURCE	BASIS
Claude Sonnet 5.5	$2 per million input tokens, $10 per million output tokens	platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/pricing, read 2026-10-15	SOURCED
Claude Haiku 5.5	$0.10 per million input tokens, $0.50 per million output tokens (prompts up to 100K tokens)	Same page	SOURCED
Base44 Free	$0; 25 message credits, 5 a day	softr.io comparison article, published 2026-07-15	SOURCED
Base44 Starter	$20 a month ($16 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED
Base44 Builder	$50 a month ($40 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED
Base44 Pro	$100 a month ($80 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED
Base44 Elite	$200 a month ($160 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED

ITEM	PRICE	SOURCE	BASIS
Figma	Free plan for personal use	Assumed from current practice; verify	ESTIMATE
Custom domain	About $12 to $20 a year	General market range; verify at a registrar	ESTIMATE

> The Base44 prices come from a third-party article, not Base44's own page, which I could not read. Check the live pricing before you pick a plan. A private app needs a paid plan. TO CONFIRM

Usage assumptions

- Each active family triggers 12 guidance requests a month, each with about 1,200 input and 500 output tokens. ESTIMATE
- Planned chatbot: 6 conversations a month per active family, 6 turns each, about 2,500 input and 400 output tokens per turn. ESTIMATE
- Whether the app calls the Claude API directly or through Base44's built-in integrations decides how this cost is billed. The tables assume direct API pricing. TO CONFIRM

AI cost per month

ACTIVE FAMILIES	GUIDANCE, SONNET	GUIDANCE, HAIKU	CHATBOT, SONNET	CHATBOT, HAIKU	TOTAL, SONNET	TOTAL, HAIKU
100	$8.88	$0.44	$32.40	$1.62	$41.28	$2.06
1,000	$88.80	$4.44	$324.00	$16.20	$412.80	$20.64
5,000	$444.00	$22.20	$1,620.00	$81.00	$2,064.00	$103.20

Monthly run cost by scenario

Hosting uses Base44 Builder at $50 for 100 and 1,000 families and Pro at $100 for 5,000. The domain adds about $1.25 a month. ESTIMATE

ACTIVE FAMILIES	HOSTING	TOTAL WITH SONNET	TOTAL WITH HAIKU	YEAR, SONNET	YEAR, HAIKU
100	$50	$92.53	$53.31	$1,110	$640
1,000	$50	$464.05	$71.89	$5,569	$863
5,000	$100	$2,165.25	$204.45	$25,983	$2,453

One-time and project costs

ITEM	COST	NOTES	BASIS
Design and build tools so far	$0 to $50	Figma free; Claude subscriptions used for the build are not counted here	ESTIMATE
Research thank-you gift cards	$150 to $250	10 interviews at $15 to $25	ESTIMATE

ITEM	COST	NOTES	BASIS
Survey tool	$0	Free form tool	ESTIMATE
Legal and privacy review before public launch	$0 to $500	Template policy, or a short consultation	ESTIMATE
Contingency (15%)	Add 15% to the total of the items above		PROPOSED

> Labor is not charged. Effort is estimated at about 9 weeks for phases 1 to 5, and about 9 to 14 weeks for the research, chatbot, shared capsule and beta phases. See the charter. ESTIMATE

Break-even view

At 1,000 active families and the smaller model, monthly cost is about $72. A $4.99 monthly plan would need about 15 paying families to cover it, before payment fees. That is about 1.5% of 1,000 families. ESTIMATE

Cost controls

- Use the smaller model for routine guides and keep the larger one for the chatbot.
- Cache generated guides by country and age, so the same guide is not generated twice.
- Set a monthly spending limit in the API console and alert at 80%.
- Review the bill each month during the beta.

Open items

- Confirm which Base44 plan the app uses today. TO CONFIRM
- Confirm how the app calls Claude: direct key or Base44 integration. TO CONFIRM
- Confirm real monthly active families when beta starts. TO CONFIRM